

SPORTOURAMS

By Joe Gootter

A new racetrack (which shapes up as a mighty handy way to make moola, especially if you're on the operations end of the stick) opens tonight. It's the Monticello Raceway, harness racetrack making its bow in the Catskill resort area.

Customers at the new track may rub elbows with carpenters as they head for the window. Construction has not been completed yet. However, there is one certainty: nothing is wrong with the machines that take the money.

Years ago, Hal Trosky was playing a vigorous batting role in the Cleveland Indians' teepee. As a first baseman with power, he contributed plenty of home run smashes to the club's attack in an era when Bob Feller was mowing them down.

Now, his 21-year-old Hal Jr., who has two youngsters of his own, is a big league prospect. A pitcher with the Colorado Springs team which has been riding the roof of the western league, he marked up a no-hitter against Des Moines. It was an extremely well-pitched game and young Trosky registered it — with excellent timing — on Father's Day.

Dad's timing wasn't as good, however. The former big leaguer and his wife had visited their son for a while but left the day before he pitched his classic.

Every once in a while, a play bobs up which is not covered in the rulebook and it causes officials to howl for legislation to cover same.

Such a play occurred in a game between Louisville and Denver a little over a week ago and the former club's apparently-valid protest died for want of a rule to cover the situation. As a result, President Ed Doherty of the American Association, is seeking a measure to make up for the deficiency as soon as possible.

The situation, as described in a report from Louisville in the Sporting News, had Denver leading, 7-5 with none out in the eighth inning. Vern Rapp was on third base and Curt Hardaway on second when batter John Kucab hit a liner to Right Fielder Chuck Oertel of the Colonels.

Rapp tagged up and headed for home after the catch. Oertel's throw about ten feet to the third base side of the plate arrived in Catcher Jack Parks' mitt about the same moment that Rapp collided with Parks' left leg blocking the plate.

Parks swung the mitt around too late to make a tag and the force of the collision sent Rapp reeling head-first toward the plate. He landed on his right cheekbone, tearing the lower eyelid, but failed to touch the plate.

Umpire Barney Deary made a "safe" signal, and Louisville players and Manager Del Wilber stormed him immediately.

Denver players, Manager Andy Cohen and Trainer Bill Behm gathered around Rapp, who was knocked unconscious.

Rapp was revived in about ten minutes while the argument raged and he headed for the dugout. Just before he reached it, Pitcher Rolf Scheel of Louisville obtained the ball and tagged Rapp, whereupon Deary signalled "out."

Base Umpire Walt Doyle disallowed this ruling, saying that he had called "time" when the argument started to prevent Hardaway from walking home from third base, where he had advanced on the play at the plate.

After another seven or eight minutes of arguing, Deary threw a ball to Scheel on the mound and ordered play resumed. Rapp, meanwhile, stood a couple of feet off home plate and stepped on it as Scheel threw the ball home. Umpire Deary ruled him "safe" and Wilber announced he was playing the game under protest.

When the Colonels prepared to follow up with an official protest the next day, they couldn't find a rule upon which to base it. Umpires, Doherty, and Louisville officials searched the rule book from cover to cover but could find nothing which specified where Rapp should stand when play was resumed.

They agreed it was unfair for him to be right upon the plate, but nobody could say where he should have been.

Denver eventually won the game, 11 to 6.

Another father who has reason to be proud of his athletic son is George Slingerland, Fair Lawn golf pro who experienced the happy thrill which comes with a championship for Junior.

The younger George won the state Public Golf championship Wednesday and it was a happy day for Senior who had taught him—and many hundreds of others—how.

In the process of winning the title, young Slingerland bested Stu Moseleski whose father is the Ridgewood High School coach. To reach the finals, both juniors played like seniors. Added touch: Moseleski defeated Tom Sanior in the semis, Senior no doubt playing like a junior.